

New-hire and leaver IT checklist

So a new person can work on day one, and nobody keeps access after their last day. Keep it with your payroll and HR onboarding paperwork.

New hire

Before day one (start at offer acceptance)

- ☐ Tell whoever handles IT the name, start date, job and manager, and what the job needs: email groups, shared folders, apps, phone. Do not copy a long-time employee's access.
- ☐ Create the email account, assign a license, and add the right groups, shared mailboxes and calendars.
- ☐ Set up the computer: updates, disk encryption, endpoint protection, a standard (non-admin) user.
- ☐ Create logins for business apps, the payroll or HR portal and the phone extension. Order keys, a fob and an alarm code.

Day one

- ☐ First sign-in together. They set their own password and set up multi-factor sign-in (MFA) before anything else.
- ☐ Set up the password manager. No passwords on sticky notes or in spreadsheets.
- ☐ They read and sign the IT and AI acceptable-use policies.
- ☐ Show them how to report a suspicious email and who to call for IT help.

First week

- ☐ Security awareness training is assigned and finished.
- ☐ Their work is saved in company storage that is backed up, not on the desktop.
- ☐ Record what was issued: laptop, phone, fob, keys, serial numbers.
- ☐ The manager checks the access: nothing missing, nothing extra.

Microsoft 365: security defaults or Conditional Access make new users register for MFA. *Google Workspace:* enforce 2-Step Verification and keep the new-user enrollment period short.

Leaver

The owner or HR tells IT the date and time ahead, in confidence. Then, in order:

- ☐ **1. Disable sign-in first.** At the agreed time, reset the password, block sign-in and sign the person out of every session.
- ☐ **2. MFA devices.** Remove their phone, authenticator app and app passwords from the account. Remove company email from personal phones.
- ☐ **3. Mail.** Forward new mail to the manager, or turn the mailbox into a shared one. Add an auto-reply naming the new contact.
- ☐ **4. Devices.** Recover the laptop, phone, keys, fob and company card. Check the laptop's files before wiping it.
- ☐ **5. Files.** Transfer file ownership to the manager before any account is deleted.
- ☐ **6. Shared passwords.** Remove them from the password manager. Change every shared password they knew: bank and vendor portals, Wi-Fi, social media.
- ☐ **7. Other systems.** Business apps, payroll or HR portal, bank user, remote-access tools, voicemail. Check they do not own the domain, website or social accounts.
- ☐ **8. Building.** Fob, keys, alarm and door codes, camera app.
- ☐ **9. Last.** Remove the license or delete the account only after mail and files are handled. Note the date of each step.

Microsoft 365: "Block sign-in" can take up to 24 hours, so also reset the password and use "Sign out of all sessions". A shared mailbox under 50 GB needs no license. Do not delete an account that forwarding depends on. A deleted user's mail and OneDrive files are kept for 30 days.

Google Workspace: suspending a user blocks sign-in and keeps the data, but new mail to that address is blocked too, so have IT reroute it. Transfer Drive files before deleting. A deleted account can be restored for up to 20 days.